



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

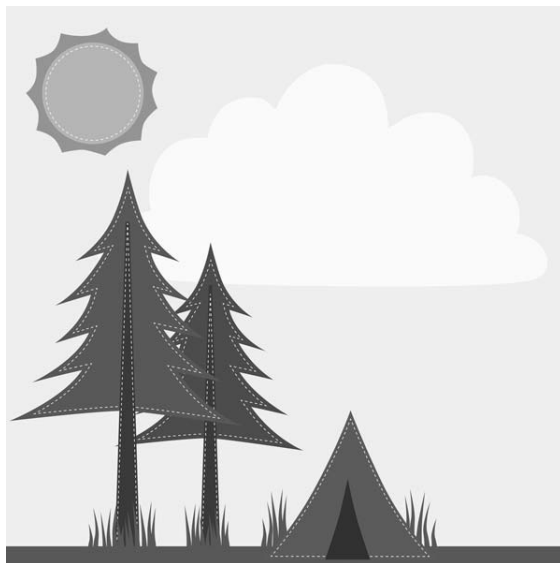
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Let's Start!

It's wonderful to camp in the woods in the fall!



Learning Outcome

Describe situations in written and spoken interactions according to social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you or someone you know went camping?
- What are the pros and cons of camping?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship, family, feelings and reactions.
- I can tell stories and anecdotes and talk about experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about things that happened or were happening.





Let's Explore!

I just **laughed off*** her good advice!

* When you "laugh something off" you play down its importance.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

My friends and I have always enjoyed camping. We've gone every year since we've been old enough to be out on our own. I have always prided myself as being the consummate camper. Last week, I wasn't. We decided to hit the woods early Saturday morning. We packed our sleeping bags and made sure the batteries in the flashlights worked. Just as we were leaving, my mom appeared and reminded me to take a warm sweater. I was feeling a bit embarrassed in front of the guys, so I passed it off. The sun was shining and it was promising to be another hot sticky day.

She looked down at the shoes I was wearing and asked if they were the only pair of shoes I was taking. I've often packed extras, but again the sun said no. When I haven't seen a cloud all day, the extra weight makes no sense! I just laughed it off.

That night at the campsite after dinner, it clouded over. A chill wind started up. Thunder was crashing. Lightning flashed across the sky. Within a few minutes it was raining cats and dogs. I was cold, wet, and my shoes were completely soaked through. My friends and I were complaining. We were wishing we had rain gear. The next day we all came down with colds. Mom has never been one to say 'I told you so'. I knew I had just been stubborn and was paying for it.





Let's Practice!

What was going on before Jane left?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Circle the correct option to complete the sentences.

We 1. _____ (**deciding / decided / decide**) to hit the woods early Saturday morning. We 2. _____ (**packed / pack / package**) our sleeping bags and made sure the batteries in the flashlights worked. Just as we 3. _____ (**were left / were leaving / leave**), my mom appeared and reminded me to take a warm sweater. I 4. _____ (**felt / feel / was feeling**) a bit embarrassed in front of the guys, so I passed it off. The sun 5. _____ (**was shining / was shone / shine**) and it was promising to be another hot sticky day.



Let's Practice!

How does Jane feel about camping?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Cross out the wrong words. Write the sentences correctly. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. My friends and I have always enjoy camping.
2. I was feeling a bit embraced in front of the guys, so I passed it off.
3. Mom has never been one to say 'I told you so'. I knew I had just been stubor and was paying for it.
4. My friends and I were complained about the rain. We were wishing we had rain gear.
5. When I haven't seen a cloud all day, the extra weight makes no sense! I just laugh it off.





Extension Activity

Recount a story about a camping trip.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm ideas about things that could happen on a camping trip.
- Put your ideas on a timeline then add vocabulary for feelings and reactions.
- Write out the story talking about things that happened or were happening in the past.
- Read your finished story to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm ideas for a camping trip story.

☐ ☐

I put the story on a timeline and add vocabulary.

☐ ☐

I use the Past Simple and Past Continuous tenses to tell the story.

☐ ☐

I share my story with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to pride (oneself)** (expression): to place value on a skill or good quality one has
e.g. I have always prided myself on being the perfect camper.
- consummate** (adjective): extremely skilled; perfect
e.g. I am the consummate camper.
- flashlight** (noun): a small electric lamp that uses batteries and that you can hold in your hand
e.g. We made sure the batteries in the flashlights worked.
- sticky** (adjective): warm, wet weather
e.g. It was promising to be another hot sticky day.
- to start up** (verb): the act of activating, turning on, or setting in motion
e.g. A chill wind started up.
- thunder** (noun): the sudden loud noise which comes after a flash of lightning
e.g. The thunder was crashing.
- lightning** (noun): a flash, or several flashes, of very bright light in the sky caused by electricity
e.g. Lightning flashed across the sky.
- raining cats and dogs** (expression): raining very heavily
e.g. Within a few minutes it was raining cats and dogs.
- soaked through** (expression): extremely wet in every part
e.g. My shoes were completely soaked through.





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

My friends and I have always enjoyed camping. = We enjoyed camping in the past and we still enjoy it now.

It is common to use *for* and *since* when referring to time periods in the Present Perfect:

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, two days, five hours, six years, etc.).
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, she was a child).

*We've gone every year **since** we've been old enough to be out on our own.*

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

Yesterday, I went to the store.

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the Present Perfect. (~~*Yesterday, I have been to the store.*~~)

Examples:

- *My friends and I have always enjoyed camping.*
- *We've gone every year since we've been old enough to be out on our own.*
- *I have always prided myself on being the consummate camper.*
- *Mom has never been one to say 'I told you so'.*





Learning Points

- *We decided to hit the woods early Saturday morning.*
- *We packed our sleeping bags and made sure the batteries in the flashlights worked.*

The Past Continuous Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about an action that was happening at a time before now.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the Past Continuous to describe the background in a story written in the past tense.

For example:

*The sun **was shining** and it **was promising** to be another hot sticky day.*

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous together. You can use the Past Continuous to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action (Simple Past).

For example:

*Just as **we were leaving**, my mom **appeared** and **reminded** me to take a warm sweater.*

The form of the Past Continuous is:

Subject + *was/were* + verb-*ing*

Examples:

- *We decided to hit the woods early Saturday morning.*
- *We packed our sleeping bags and made sure the batteries in the flashlights worked.*
- *Just as we were leaving, my mom appeared and reminded me to take a warm sweater.*
- *I was feeling a bit embarrassed in front of the guys, so I passed it off.*
- *The sun was shining and it was promising to be another hot sticky day.*
- *She looked down at the shoes I was wearing and asked if they were the only pair of shoes I was taking.*
- *My friends and I were complaining.*
- *We were wishing we had raingear.*
- *The next day we all came down with colds.*

